

Deliverable 2: Breach Case Study Analysis

Equifax Data Breach (2017)

Introduction

In 2017, Equifax, a credit reporting company, experienced one of the largest data breaches in history. Hackers gained access to the personal information of about 147 million people.

Cause of the Breach

The breach happened because the company did not update software that had a known security weakness. Attackers used this weakness to enter the company's systems.

Information Stolen

The attackers stole:

- Names, Dates of birth, Addresses, Social Security numbers, Driver's licence numbers

Impact

The breach caused:

- Identity theft risks for customers.
- Financial losses.
- Damage to Equifax's reputation.
- Legal investigations and fines.

Lessons Learned

This shows that companies should:

- Update software regularly.
- Fix security vulnerabilities quickly.
- Monitor their systems.
- Train employees in cybersecurity.
- Use strong security controls.

Conclusion

The Equifax breach shows that poor security can have serious consequences. Regular updates and good cybersecurity practices help protect company and customer information.